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FoodEx2 maintenance 2025

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Abstract

FoodEx2, developed and maintained by EFSA, is a comprehensive system designed to classify and describe food and feed products. It provides a harmonised and standardised terminology framework that supports the entire food safety and risk assessment workflow, from data collection across multiple food and feed safety domains (e.g., monitoring of pesticides residues or biological hazards) to exposure assessment. To ensure the system remains relevant and aligned with evolving scientific and legislative requirements, regular updates are essential. To date, eight major updates have been completed, each documented in annual maintenance reports. This technical report presents the outcome of the ninth maintenance cycle carried out in 2025. The updates introduced include the addition of new terms, refinements to the hierarchical structure, revision to the reportability of selected terms, and amendments to existing terms – such as update to implicit facets, improvements to implicit attributes and scope notes and adjustments to parent-child relationships.

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Summary

FoodEx2 is a standardised food classification and description system developed by EFSA. It aims to enhance the comparability and exchange of data across food safety domains under EFSA's scope. To ensure the system remains current and adaptable to evolving data collections needs, it undergoes continuous maintenance. Since the major revision published in April 2015 (FoodEx2 revision 2), annual maintenance cycles of the system have been implemented.

A maintenance technical group, comprising EFSA staff with expertise in areas such as food consumption, chemical contaminants, pesticides residues and other, reviews proposals and requests submitted by users and stakeholders and determines whether and how they should be incorporated. Following the first maintenance in 2015, eight major releases were issued between 2016 and 2025.

During the last (ninth) maintenance cycle performed in 2025, several updates were introduced. A total of 79 new terms were added across various hierarchies and/or facets to support new data collections (notably, the One Health Surveillance), ongoing data collections (such as the Avian Influenza monitoring programmes and the Chemical monitoring data collection) and requests from external and internal users. Moreover, amendments to existing terms were implemented to reflect updated needs of new and existing data collections.

Amendments to different sections of the catalogue were implemented during the maintenance of 2025. For the purposes of the Chemical monitoring data collection, new terms were added and amendments of existing terms were implemented. In the context of Food Additives and Food Flavourings Monitoring data collection, the mapping between the FoodEx2 base terms with the legislative classes defined in the Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on food additives was updated. Additional changes were introduced to support the development of the open-access European Food Composition Database (EU FCDB), including new and revised terms across different hierarchies. Updates were also made to the natural sources hierarchy to support the Novel Foods Risk Assessment Data Modelling and Extraction (NORA) project, aimed at improving the risk assessment of novel foods (NF).

The 'Bird (as animal)' section within the F01 – Source facet underwent extensive restructuring to meet the requirements of Avian Influenza surveillance in poultry and wild birds. This included completing the taxonomy, adding new and updating existing terms, updating term names, implicit attributes and scope notes and adjusting parent-child relationships.

As part of the review, five terms (n=5) were identified as redundant or misaligned with current use and were therefore dismissed from the relevant hierarchies.

The present report summarises the outcome of the ninth maintenance process conducted in 2025, covering the changes delivered through three minor releases published in 2025 (MTX 16.1, MTX 16.2, and MTX 16.3) and the major release published in January 2026 (MTX 17.0).

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1 Background and terms of reference as provided by the requestor

In 2011, EFSA released a comprehensive food classification and description system named FoodEx2 (revision 1) (EFSA, 2011a, b). This system was developed with the aim of harmonising the description of the food matrices within data collections in different food safety domains. Following the publication, a testing phase was carried out to highlight strengths and weaknesses of the classification and to identify possible issues and needs for refinement. Based on the outcome of the testing phase, EFSA revised the system and in 2015 the second revision of the food classification and description system (FoodEx2 revision 2) was published (EFSA, 2015).

According to the guidance documents on FoodEx2 (EFSA, 2011a, 2015), internal and external users should provide to EFSA proposals for implementation and maintenance to refine the system and an annual EFSA Maintenance Technical Group (TG) should be set up to evaluate the suggestions and decide on their implementation. In fact, innovation in the food market and gained experience by using the system led to the need of keeping the catalogue updated. Following the revision 2 of the system, the FoodEx2 catalogue was revised seven times based on EFSA needs and evaluation of the data providers and stakeholders' suggestions. A first maintenance took place in 2015 (EFSA et al., 2016) followed by seven major releases performed between 2016-2024. The updated catalogues (MTX 10.0, MTX 11.0, MTX 12.0, MTX 13.0, MTX 14.0, MTX 15.0 and MTX 16.0) and the technical reports that summarize all changes performed during the maintenance from 2016 - 2024 were published (EFSA, 2019b, EFSA, 2020, EFSA, 2021b, EFSA, 2022, EFSA, 2023, EFSA, 2024, EFSA, 2025).

Moreover, harmonized data collection in the areas of pesticides, contaminant occurrence, veterinary medicinal product residues and food additives (EFSA, 2026), as well as on zoonoses, zoonotic agents, antimicrobial resistance and foodborne outbreaks (EFSA, 2026), is reflected in the maintenance process of the FoodEx2 catalogue. Considering that all the above data domains and several other ad-hoc data collections in EFSA use the FoodEx2 catalogue (e.g., food consumption, botanicals etc.), there was a need to accommodate different requests. Some changes were performed to enable giving a clear guidance (in terms of FoodEx2 codes) to data providers before the data collection launch date, while others were requested from EFSA staff working in different domains, data providers and network members (hereafter stated as users).

By using the system, both internal and external users and stakeholders provided constructive comments and requests for addition of missing terms and other type of updates in different sections of the catalogue. All these suggestions were considered for the maintenance purposes. A technical group composed of EFSA staff with expertise in different domains carried out the maintenance process, evaluating whether and how to implement the received suggestions in the FoodEx2 system.

The present report describes the outcome of the ninth maintenance process undertaken in 2025 to keep track of the changes in the system implemented within three minor releases published in 2025 (MTX 16.1, MTX 16.2 and MTX 16.3) and the major release published in January 2026 (MTX 17.0). To perform a correct coding, with a reasonable level of detail, this report should be read in conjunction with the technical report 'The food classification and description system FoodEx2 (revision 2)' (EFSA, 2015) where the logic and the structure of the system and the rules for the correct use of FoodEx2 are described.

2 Data and methodologies

2.1 Data

The FoodEx2 catalogue MTX 16.0 - version published in January 2025 was used as a starting point. The suggestions provided during the period between January 2025 and January 2026 by users and stakeholders of the FoodEx2 system were collected through written feedback and used to update the system.

2.2 Methodologies

Each request for additions or structural changes was carefully evaluated. Based on expert judgment, the TG determined whether a change was needed, or the request was already addressed by the existing terms and facet descriptors. All changes adhered to the system's established structure and underlying logic, as described in the report on the development of FoodEx2 revision 2 (EFSA, 2015).

2.2.1 Maintenance Process

To carry out the ninth maintenance of the FoodEx2 catalogue, the TG performed the following steps:

- Evaluation of the requests, comments and proposals from internal and external stakeholders
- Decision on the implementation of the proposals based on the following options: addition of new terms, extension or better specification of the scope of existing terms or identification of the correct way of implementing the suggestion using already existing terms and rules, change of the parent-child relationship of the terms, deprecation and setting of terms as not reportable/dismissed in one hierarchy but still reportable in others.
- Checking for inconsistencies and ambiguities
- Update of the FoodEx2 catalogue
- Summary of the changes for the present technical report.

2.2.2 Tools

The tool used for implementing the maintenance within the three minor releases published in 2025 (MTX 16.1, MTX 16.2 and MTX 16.3) and the changes during the major release published in January 2026 (MTX 17.0) was the new internal catalogue management tool developed under EFSA's Rebuild Data Framework (DF) project. The term naming, scope notes and implicit attributes of some terms were updated using the SAS (SAS Institute Inc., Cary, NC, USA) Enterprise guide 8.3.

3 Maintenance Output

The following sections provide a detailed explanation of the maintenance activities carried out along with the rationale behind each change. The overview is organised according to the impacted food safety domains, stakeholders needs, and legislative developments driving the updates. Additionally, horizontal changes – i.e., updates not linked to specific data collection – were also introduced to improve the overall consistency of the system. These impacted various aspects including the implicit attributes, parent child relationship and/or implicit facets of existing terms from different hierarchies (see Appendix A). As part of this review, improved placement within the classification was identified for two terms. In particular, the composite dish which is based on tropical root/tuber vegetable ('A18TH Tropical root and tuber vegetable dishes') was reorganised under the term 'A03VC Dishes excluding pasta or rice dishes, sandwiches and pizza' in all hierarchies where this base term is reportable including Reporting and Exposure hierarchies. Furthermore, the Neufchâtel cheese ('A18BB Cheese, neufchatel') which is mostly associated with the food group of soft-ripened cheeses with bloomy rind was reclassified under the parent term 'A02RT Soft-ripened cheese with bloomy rind (white mould) (brie, camembert type)' in the different hierarchies where it is reportable.

A comprehensive table detailing all changes performed in 2025, along with the affected hierarchies and facets and the rationale behind them, is available in Appendix A.

3.1 Updates for the Avian Influenza surveillance data collection

FoodEx2 is used for reporting data under the Avian Influenza surveillance programmes in poultry and wild birds, carried out by Member States, according to Regulation (EU) 2016/429 and Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/689¹. To meet the data reporting requirements in this domain, the Bird section, 'A057X – Bird (as animal)', was updated in the maintenance process in 2025 due to the addition of new birds species requested by data providers to be added to the MTX (FoodEx2). An overall curation of this section was also performed. This revision involved detailed evaluation of the term names, common names, scientific names/synonyms, scope notes, Euring codes, completion of taxonomy (missing terms for order, family and genus of existing species) and parent-child relationships to keep the hierarchy up to date and maintain the consistency of the existing hierarchical structure.

An external expert in ornithology was engaged under EFSA's Individual Scientific Advisors (ISA) scheme to provide scientific and technical support in ecosystem analysis. The task involved the assessment of the new birds to be added in the FoodEx2 catalogue requested by data providers and an overall curation of the current taxonomy as well as the collection of detailed information relevant to term names, common names, scientific names, Euring codes etc. Thus, necessary changes and amendments to the current taxonomy were proposed.

To accommodate data providers' requests for the Avian Influenza data collection and keep the hierarchy complete, $n = 32$ new bird species have been added and made those reportable in the F01 – Source facet during the maintenance process of 2025. The newly added taxonomic entities included one order ($n=1$), one family ($n=1$), six genera ($n=6$), three species ($n=3$) and twenty-one subspecies ($n=21$). Euring² codes were attributed to 22 terms, reported as necessary for the Avian Influenza Data Collection. Furthermore, the F02 Part-nature facet was updated with one new code ($n=1$) related to non-food animal related matrices (see section 3.6.3). In addition

¹ Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/689 of 17 December 2019 supplementing Regulation (EU) 2016/429 of the European Parliament and of the Council as regards rules for surveillance, eradication programmes, and disease-free status for certain listed and emerging diseases (Text with EEA relevance). OJ L 174, 3.6.2020, p. 211–340.

² Euring is the coordinating organisation for European bird ringing schemes which maintains a databank containing ringing recovery information gathered throughout Europe.

to this, the scope notes of one term code (n=1) within the same facet category were revised to provide a more accurate description of the term.

This systematic revision also motivated changes in existing terms, which were associated with: 1) update or addition of new common and/or scientific names, 2) update of the term extended name, 3) removal of existing common names and/or scientific names to ensure more accurate description of the term names, 4) update of the Euring code assigned as implicit attribute and 5) alterations to parent-child relationships. Term extended names were updated for 21 codes, common names were added or updated for 31 terms, while scientific name/synonyms were added or updated for 31 terms. The Euring code was amended for one term code ('A181S Common Stonechat (as animal)') and it is now mapped to the Eurings Code '11391'. A new parent term was assigned to 26 codes mostly due to the addition of missing genera and/or family in taxonomy (see section 3.6.2). Consequently, scope notes were updated for 340 terms, reflecting the changes in common and/or scientific names and maintaining a consistent approach of describing the terms under this section (see Appendix A).

3.2 Updates for the One Health surveillance data collection

FoodEx2 is used for reporting data under the One Health Surveillance data collection according to the Commission Implementing Decision of 25.7.2023 amending Implementing Decision C(2022) 317 final of 14 January 2022 on the financing of the Programme for the Union's action in the field of health ('EU4Health Programme') and the adoption of the work programme for 2022³. The European Commission (EC) has allocated specific resources for Member States for setting up a coordinated surveillance system under the One Health approach for cross-border pathogens that threaten the Union. The results of this surveillance are collected by EFSA to perform a risk assessment aiming at identifying One Health zoonotic risks for the EU for which surveillance is needed and allowing for an iterative approach which would allow to review the surveillance priorities. The data for the One Health surveillance are referring to pathogen detection in livestock, wildlife, vectors and environmental samples.

To meet the data reporting requirements in this domain, different hierarchies and/or facets of the MTX (FoodEx2) were updated during the maintenance of 2025. The amendments were associated with the addition of new terms as natural sources or facets. Furthermore, updates on existing codes were also implemented to respect the minimum level of detail required for this data collection.

In particular, thirteen new terms (n=13) were added in F01- Source facet and F34- Host-sampled facet. The new terms were added in Mammals section, 'A056H Mammals (as animal)' which contains the animals belonging to the class Mammalia. The newly added taxonomic entities included one infraorder (n=1), one order (n=1), one family (n=1), one genus (n=1), and nine species (n=9). Moreover, a new facet descriptor ('Domesticated') was created and added to the F21 Production-method facet hierarchy.

Furthermore, amendments to existing term codes within the 'Mammals' section in the F01- Source facet hierarchy were performed. These updates have also been applied to the F34 Host-sampled facet hierarchy, in which the existing term codes are reportable. In particular, the changes were associated with the update of common and/or scientific names and the update of term extended names. Therefore, the scope notes of these terms were amended to reflect these

³ COMMISSION IMPLEMENTING DECISION of 25.7.2023 amending Implementing Decision C(2022) 317 final of 14 January 2022 on the financing of the Programme for the Union's action in the field of health ('EU4Health Programme') and the adoption of the work programme for 2022. Available here: https://health.ec.europa.eu/document/download/18379bcf-ef74-4c7d-9614-dacf3e1d10b9_en?filename=c_2023_5052_1_act_en.pdf

changes (see Appendix A). In addition, changes related to the parent-child relationships were implemented to allow data providers to report data at the minimum level of detail required. For further details see section 3.6.2.

3.3 Updates for the data collection in preparation for the EU Food Composition Database (EU FCDB)

Food composition databases are essential tools providing detailed information about the nutrients and other components found in foods. They are necessary for nutrition intake assessment, food policy, and health-related research. EFSA's food composition database, established in 2013, hosts data for seven countries (Finland, France, Germany, Italy, Netherlands, Sweden, and United Kingdom). However, the rapid development of the food industry and changing market dynamics necessitate continuous maintenance of food composition data. To address these ongoing changes and create an up-to-date source of information, EFSA will develop and publish a comprehensive open-access European Food Composition database (EU FCDB), which will compile nutrient data across Europe in a harmonised format. Within this context, the food composition data on food (including fortified foods) and food supplements that will be collected and submitted to EFSA should be mapped to FoodEx2 food classification and description system.

To meet the data reporting requirements under this domain, during the maintenance window of 2025, five new terms (n=5) were created and made reportable in different facet hierarchies. Two new terms (n=2) related to special diets were created and made reportable in the F23 Target-consumer facet. Furthermore, three new facet descriptors related to the cooking and similar thermal preparation processes were added in the F28 Process facet (for more details see sections 3.6.6 and 3.6.7, respectively).

In addition to this, a revision of the F28 -Process facet hierarchy was performed which motivated changes in existing terms. These amendments were associated with: 1) update of new common names, 2) update of the term extended name, 3) update of scope notes to ensure more accurate description of the terms, 4) the update of the level of detail and 5) the alterations to parent-child relationships (for more details see Appendix A and section 3.6.7).

3.4 Updates in the context of the Novel Foods Risk Assessment Data Modelling and Extraction (NORA) project

The Novel Foods Risk Assessment Data Modelling and Extraction (NORA) project, commissioned by EFSA and conducted by EcoMole s.r.o., aimed to improve the risk assessment process for novel foods (NFs). To meet the objectives of this project, a new data model was developed based on existing data structures within EFSA and other organisations. This data model was used to extract data from existing published opinions on NFs into a structured database. In the frame of this project, FoodEx2 was also employed to ensure a high level of standardization and compatibility with EFSA databases.

According to the FoodEx2 logic, the F01- Source facet hierarchy was updated to support the development of the NORA database. In order to describe the plant or organism identity of the NF, ten new terms (n=10) were added in the F01- Source facet. The majority of new terms were incorporated as plants into the Plants section, 'A058Y Plants (as plant)', whereas other terms were added as organisms under the sections of 'A05RR Fungi (as organism)' and 'A05MF Marine algae (as organism)'. The incorporation of different aspects related to NFs into the catalogue makes FoodEx2 more flexible and suitable for new data collections, ensuring that the system remains up to date and capable of supporting future developments in innovative food production.

3.5 Updates for the Chemical Monitoring data collection

In the frame of the Chemical Monitoring data collection, EFSA receives data in the areas of pesticides residues, contaminant occurrence, veterinary medicinal product residues and food additives. During the FoodEx2 maintenance of 2025, new terms were created and updates to existing term codes in different hierarchies were implemented to meet the data reporting requirements in these domains. The detailed changes performed are available in Appendix A. In the following sub-sections, an explanation of the amendments carried out particularly in the context of food additives and pesticides residues is also provided.

3.5.1 Updates for the Food Additives and Food Flavourings Monitoring data collection

In accordance with Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 and Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008 the consumption and use of food additives and food flavourings shall be monitored, and data shall be gathered to assess that their use does not raise a health concern. Following a new EC Mandate, EFSA must collect data from the Member States, starting with the first pilot in 2025, for monitoring the occurrence (analytical results via the Chemical Monitoring data collection), use levels and presence of food additives and flavourings.

To meet the data reporting requirements in these domains and keep the catalogue up to date, the F33 – Legislative- classes facet descriptors under 'A163R Food additive classes (1333/2008)' was revised in the maintenance window of 2025. Due to the updated guidance document with the food legislative categories that are described in Part E of Annex II of Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on food additives, the section 'A163R Food additive classes (1333/2008)' within F33 Legislative classes facet was enriched with four new terms (n=4). In addition to this, the term extended names of existing terms were updated to be in line with the new version of the guidance document (see section 3.6.10 for further details).

A new term for 'Bitter liqueur' was added under the parent term 'A03NV Herb liqueur' and made reportable to different hierarchies, including Reporting and Exposure hierarchies (see Appendix A). Furthermore, amendments in terms of the implicit facets, reportability and the parent child relationships of existing term codes were implemented during the maintenance of 2025. In particular, the mapping between FoodEx2 base terms, which are reportable in different hierarchies including Reporting and Exposure hierarchies, with the F33- Legislative - classes defined in the Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on food additives was updated. In particular, the implicit facets in terms of the F33 facet was revised for twenty-one base terms (n=21). Furthermore, one term ('A0C5V FA-0. All categories of foods) was made not reportable and it is not allowed to be used for the exposure assessment as it was too generic, and it may not allow a precise estimation. Lastly, the term 'A035M Chewing gum' was reclassified under the parent 'A04PE Confectionery including chocolate' instead of being a part of 'A0EQP Soft candies and analogues' since it was considered to be an independent sub-category from any other soft or hard candies.

Enhancements on the FoodEx2 system were also proposed and implemented to facilitate the exposure assessment work carried out for food additives. These included the creation of new terms added in different hierarchies and/or facets. In the food additives legislative framework, restrictions often apply to food supplements when different maximum permitted levels for additives are set depending on the form of the product (e.g., syrup-type and drops or effervescent and chewable tablets). To capture these variations in physical state, new descriptors (n=4) were added to the F03 – Physical State facet (see more details in section 3.6.4).

Furthermore, a new base term for 'Iced tea' was created and made reportable in different hierarchies including Reporting and Exposure hierarchies. This new term was incorporated into

the catalogue to avoid the inconsistent way of reporting these beverages which might eventually resulted in the assignment of the incorrect food additive legislation category. For this purpose, the new term was mapped with the appropriate F33 - Legislative - classes facet for food additive (i.e., 'A0C1T FA-14.1.4 Flavoured drinks').

3.5.2 Updates for the Pesticides residues data collection

The catalogue was also revised for the purposes of the pesticides residues data collection, and in line with Annex I of the Regulation (EC) No 396/2005 on maximum residue levels of pesticides⁴. An update of the implicit attribute "matrixCode", which associates a FoodEx2 term with its corresponding legislative category specifying its applicable Maximum Residue Limit (MRL) was performed on seven terms (n=7). During the maintenance window of 2025, the matrix code for one term (n=1) was removed and for six terms (n=6) a new matrix code was added. Table 1 summarizes the updates of the matrix codes as part of the maintenance process of 2025. Furthermore, according to the updated Annex I of Regulation 396/2005⁵, a new term was created ('A1B3H Small radish leaves') and placed under 'A00LM Roman rocket and similar-' in different hierarchies. The newly created code was assigned with the matrix code 'P0251060-002'.

Furthermore, the term name of the code 'A00MB Radish leaves' was updated. In particular, the description of the term 'A00MB Radish leaves' was modified to 'A00MB Large radish leaves'. Therefore, its scope notes were amended to reflect these changes. In addition to this, the parent child relationship of this term was also updated and particularly the term was placed under the code 'A00GL Kales and similar-' in all hierarchies where it is reportable including Reporting and Exposure hierarchies. During the maintenance window 2025, the implicit facet of two terms (n=2) was also modified to provide more accurate description of the terms (see further details in Appendix A). Lastly, one term was made not reportable in the 'Reporting' hierarchy since it was deemed generic without providing enough details (see section 3.7).

Table 1: Updates in the matrix codes of existing FoodEx2 terms in line with Annex I of the Regulation (EC) No 396/2005 related to pesticides

FoodEx2 code	Term Extended name	matrixCode
A016V	Angelica, dry	P0632010-095
A017E	Lavender, dry	P0631030-021
A017G	Marjoram, dry	P0820040-001
A017P	Tansy and related species, dry	P0632010-089
A017S	Woodruff, dry	P0632010-088
A017T	Wormwoods, dry	P0632010-001
A01XB	Bovine and pig, fresh fat tissue	-

–, no matrixCode available

⁴ Official Journal of the European Union, Commission Regulation (EU) 2018/62, replacing Annex I to Regulation (EC) No 396/2005 of the European Parliament and of the Council https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=CELEX:32018R0062&from=EN#ntr12-L_2018018EN.01000302-E0012

⁵ [https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=PI_COM:C\(2024\)8853](https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=PI_COM:C(2024)8853)

3.6 Amendments in hierarchies and facets

3.6.1 Updates of the PRIMo hierarchy of FoodEx2

During the maintenance window of 2025, the PRIMo hierarchy of FoodEx2 was updated with one new term ('A1B3H Small radish leaves') which was added due to the Pesticides residues data collection. However, this term was added as 'not reportable' in this hierarchy to keep the consistency of the current taxonomy under the parent term 'A00LM Roman rocket and similar-'.

3.6.2 Changes in the F01 – Source facet

F01 – Source facet was amended with a total number of 55 new terms to allow mapping of samples within different data collections and projects (e.g., Avian Influenza, One Health surveillance data collection, NORA project). Due to the revision of Bird section, 'A057X –Bird (as animal)', an additional structuring in terms of completion of taxonomy and parent-child relationship was required. For more details see section 3.1. Consequently, a new position was found for twenty-six terms (n=26) within the Bird section. Furthermore, to meet the data reporting requirements of One Health surveillance data collection, new terms were created in the F01 Source facet, under Mammals section, 'A056H Mammals (as animal)' (see Appendix A). The addition of new terms led to the update of the parent for three existing terms (n=3). Table 2 summarizes the updates in terms of the new parent-child relationships in the F01- Source facet hierarchy during 2025 maintenance window.

Table 2: Update of the F01- Source facet hierarchy in terms of the new parent-child relationships during the maintenance in 2025

FoodEx2 code	Term Extended name	Source Parent Code Old	Source Parent Code New
A0CTP	Greater Rhea (as animal)	A0CSY	A1B1U
A173Z	Eurasian Spoonbill (as animal)	A187Y	A18TV
A17MT	Western Jackdaw (as animal)	A17RN	A1B3B
A17RJ	Kentish Plover (as animal)	A17XD	A1B2Y
A17XC	Eurasian Dotterel (as animal)	A17XD	A1B2X
A182P	Barred Warbler (as animal)	A182V	A1B2Z
A182Q	Lesser Whitethroat (as animal)	A182V	A1B2Z
A182R	Common Whitethroat (as animal)	A182V	A1B2Z
A18AQ	Sardinian Warbler (as animal)	A182V	A1B2Z
A18YY	Kittlitz's Plover (as animal)	A17XD	A1B2Y
A18ZC	Verreaux's Eagle-Owl (as animal)	A18NN	A1B3A
A19ZJ	Brown Fish-owl (as animal)	A17ZN	A1B3A
A1A5V	Yemen Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6N	Marmora's Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6P	Balearic Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z

A1A6Q	Dartford Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6R	Tristram's Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6S	Spectacled Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6T	Moltoni's Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6V	Menetries's Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6X	Cyprus Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6Y	Rueppell's Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A6Z	Asian Desert Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A7A	Arabian Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A7B	Western Orphean Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A1A7C	Eastern Orphean Warbler (as animal)	A188F	A1B2Z
A0CRX	Talpidae (as animal)	A056H	A1B4E
A16DD	Erinaceinae (as animal)	A056H	A1B4E
A16EA	Soricidae (as animal)	A056H	A1B4E

3.6.3 Changes in the F02 –Part-nature facet

As described in section 3.1, FoodEx2 is used for reporting data under the Avian Influenza surveillance programmes in poultry and wild birds, carried out by Member States. To allow the mapping of samples tested in this domain, the F02- Part nature was amended with one new term. Thus, a new facet descriptor for the 'A1B1E Multiple organs/tissues (as part-nature)' was added under the code 'A0CEG Non-food animal-related matrices (as part-nature)'. The purpose of this addition was to allow data providers report a sample which might refer to a mixture of more than one organ and/or tissue from the same animal. In addition to this, the scope notes of the existing term 'A16XT Organ/tissue (zoonoses) (as part-nature)' was amended to ensure the distinction between the existing term and the newly created one. For further information see Appendix A.

3.6.4 Changes in the F03 - Physical-state facet

New facet descriptors were introduced within the F03 – Physical State facet hierarchy, as described in section 3.5.1. In particular, two new facet descriptors were created under the code 'A06JH Tablets', to allow the reporting of the different types of tablets and particularly of effervescent (A1B1N) and chewable tablets (A1B1X). In addition, two new terms for drops ('A1B1O Drops') and Syrup-type ('A1B1Y Syrup-type'), respectively, were added under 'A06JL Liquid', to better describe the different types of liquid forms.

3.6.5 Changes in the F21 – Production-method facet

During the maintenance window of 2025, one new term was created within the F21 -Production – method facet hierarchy to accommodate the needs for the One Health surveillance data collection. The new term ('A1B1W Domesticated') was added to allow data providers to report accurately analytical results from pathogens identified in domestic animals which were raised in households.

3.6.6 Changes in the F23 – Target – consumer facet

To accommodate the needs of data reporting in the frame of the preparation of the open-access EU FCBD, two new facet descriptors (n=2) were added in the F23 – Target-consumer facet. These new facet descriptors were added to allow the reporting of foods recommended under special diets and in particular in the context of vegan ('A1B1Q Vegan') and vegetarian diets ('A1B1P Vegetarian').

3.6.7 Changes in the F28 – Process facet

During the maintenance window of 2025, an update of the F28- Process facet hierarchy was performed, as described in section 3.3. In particular, the facet hierarchy was updated with three new cooking processes (n=3). Two new terms were created under the term 'A07GL Boiling' to incorporate the process of draining ('A1B1L Boiling and draining') or undraining ('A1B1M Boiling and undraining'), respectively. In addition to this, a new term for the cooking process of popping was created under the parent 'A0BA1 Cooking and similar thermal preparation processes' ('A1B1K Popping'), describing the process of agitating the food over a dry, high heat source, which results in exploding, breaking the outer skin of the grain and altering its original shape.

Furthermore, the term naming and definition of existing codes were revised. In particular, a new term name was assigned to four terms (n=4). In addition to this, a new common name was added to two terms (n=2), and the scope notes were updated for ten codes (n=10) to provide a more comprehensive description of the terms. For further details see Appendix A. The parent child relationship was amended for two terms (n=2) since a more accurate position in the classification was found. Consequently, this led to the update of the level of detail to keep the consistency among the terms within the current taxonomy. Table 3 shows the amendments in terms of the new parent-child relationships and the level of detail during 2025 maintenance window. Lastly, the Languag code⁶ which is usually assigned as an implicit attribute to these facet descriptors, was updated for two terms (n=2). Table 4 presents the updates in terms of the Languag code.

Table 3: Updates in the parent-child relationship and the level of detail implemented during the maintenance in 2025

FoodEx2 code	Term Extended name	Process Parent Code New	Level of detail New
A07GK	Scalding	A0BA1	Core term
A07GQ	Pressure cooking	A0BA1	Core term

Table 4: Updates in terms of Languag code implemented during the maintenance in 2025

FoodEx2 code	Term Extended name	Languag code New
A07GP	Steaming without pressure	G0023
A07HH	Reheating in the pack	G0040

⁶ Languag is a multilingual thesaurus using faceted classifications. Each food is described by a set of standard, controlled terms chosen from facets characteristic of the nutritional and/or hygienic quality of a food, as for example the biological origin, the methods of cooking and conservation, and technological treatments.

3.6.8 Changes in the F29 – Purpose-of-raising facet

During the maintenance window of 2025, three terms were made reportable in the F29 - Purpose-of-raising facet to accommodate the needs for the baseline survey on the prevalence of methicillin-resistant *Staphylococcus aureus* (MRSA) for pigs. These terms are related to the type of the farm from which the pigs sampled were coming from ('A1A9M Farrow-to-finish', 'A1A9N Weaner-to-finish', 'A1A9P Finisher'). The new Animal Population data model required for the baseline survey that is mandatory for Member States, was aligned and followed the structure of data model used under the SIGMA project. Considering that the use of F29- Purpose- of – raising facet is expected within the context of SIGMA structure, the reportability of these facet descriptors were expanded in this facet hierarchy to allow a functioning reporting process when the type of establishment from which the animals sampled were coming from was a farm.

3.6.9 Changes in the F31 – Animal – age-class facet

To accommodate the needs of Chemical Monitoring data collection, the F31 – Animal – age class facet hierarchy was updated in terms of the addition of four new terms (n=4). The new facet descriptors were added under the parent term 'A0C8K Age classes for birds' and correspond to birds under and over 12 weeks old as well as under and over 16 weeks old respectively. The purpose of these additions lays on the fact that, the composition of animal feed might vary according to the age of the animal, which potentially will influence the presence and concentration of antibiotic substances and consequently, the applicable Maximum Residue Limit (MRL) may differ upon analysis.

3.6.10 Changes in the F33 – Legislative – classes facet

As described in section 3.5.1, the F33 Legislative classes facet hierarchy was updated with the addition of four new facet descriptors (n=4). Three new legislative classes were created under the parent term 'A0C13 FA-18. Processed foods not covered by categories 1 to 17'. Furthermore, one new legislative class related to the milk-based drinks and similar products intended for young children was added under the term code 'A0C5T FA-01. Dairy products and analogues'. For further details see Appendix A. A revision of the existing terms within this facet category was also applied. In particular, the term extended names of ten F33 food additive classes (n=10) were updated in line with Part E of Annex II of Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on food additives. Table 5 presents the old and new term extended names of the ten facet descriptors under 'A163R Food additive classes (1333/2008)' in the F33 Legislative-classes facet. In addition, as described in section 3.7, one term was set as not reportable and cannot be used anymore since it was considered redundant.

Table 5: Updates in term extended names of food additive classes within F33 Legislative-classes facet in line with Part E of Annex II of Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on food additives

FoodEx2 code	Old Term Extended name	New Term Extended Name
A0C22	FA-13.3 Dietary foods for weight control diets intended to replace total daily food intake or an individual meal (the whole or part of the total daily diet)	FA-13.3 Total diet replacement for weight control food as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013
A0C23	FA-13.2 Dietary foods for special medical purposes defined in Directive 1999/21/EC (excluding products from food category 13.1.5)	FA-13.2 Foods for special medical purposes as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013 (excluding products from food category 13.1.5)
A0C24	FA-13.1.5.2 Dietary foods for babies and young children for special medical purposes as defined in Directive 1999/21/EC	FA-13.1.5.2 Foods for special medical purposes, as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013, intended for infants as from four months of age and for young children
A0C25	FA-13.1.5.1 Dietary foods for infants for special medical purposes and special formulae for infants	FA-13.1.5.1 Foods for special medical purposes, as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013, intended for infants
A0C26	FA-13.1.5 Dietary foods for infants and young children for special medical purposes as defined by Commission Directive 1999/21/EC (3) and special formulae for infants	FA-13.1.5 Foods for special medical purposes, as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013, intended for infants and young children
A0C28	FA-13.1.3 Processed cereal-based foods and baby foods for infants and young children as defined by Commission Directive 2006/125/EC (2)	FA-13.1.3 Processed cereal-based foods and baby foods as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013
A0C29	FA-13.1.2 Follow-on formulae as defined by Directive 2006/141/EC	FA-13.1.2 Follow-on formulae as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013
A0C2A	FA-13.1.1 Infant formulae as defined by Commission Directive 2006/141/EC (1)	FA-13.1.1 Infant formulae as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013
A0C2C	FA-13. Foods intended for particular nutritional uses as defined by Directive 2009/39/EC	FA-13. Foods intended for specific groups as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013
A0C13	FA-18. Processed foods not covered by categories 1 to 17, excluding foods for infants and young children	FA-18. Processed foods not covered by categories 1 to 17

3.6.11 Changes in the F34 – Host – sampled facet

F34 – Host – sampled facet was updated with 45 new terms to allow the mapping of samples within different data collections and projects (e.g., One Health surveillance data collection, Avian Influenza). The new terms were added to the Bird section, 'A057X – Bird (as animal)', and Mammals section, 'A056H – Mammals (as animal)'. These additions resulted in refinements of the hierarchical structure and consequently the parent-child relationship was adjusted for twenty-nine terms (n=29). For further details see section 3.6.2.

3.7 Deprecated and dismissed terms during the maintenance 2025

During the maintenance window of 2025, no terms were deprecated but five terms (n=5) were considered redundant or not in line with the data used and thus were dismissed from different hierarchies and facets. In particular, two terms (n=2) were dismissed from Reporting and F33 Legislative classes facet hierarchy, respectively, and three terms (n=3) were set as not reportable from the F21 – Production method facet. Therefore, these terms cannot be used anymore in the up-coming data collections (see Table 6 – List of dismissed terms during the maintenance in 2025).

Table 6: List of dismissed terms during the maintenance in 2025

FoodEx2 code	Term Extended name	Hierarchies in which the term was dismissed
A03PX	Food for infants and young children	Reporting hierarchy
A0C5V	FA-0. All categories of foods	F33 – Legislative - classes facet
A1A9M	Farrow-to-finish	F21 – Production - method facet
A1A9N	Weaner-to-finish	F21 – Production - method facet
A1A9P	Finisher	F21 – Production - method facet

4 Conclusion

The present report documents the update of FoodEx2 performed within three minor releases published in 2025 (MTX 16.1, MTX 16.2, and MTX 16.3) and the major release published in January 2026 (MTX 17.0), covering requests from internal and external users.

- In total, 79 new terms have been added to the catalogue since the last major release 16.0
- Throughout the 2025 maintenance window, 358 scope notes have been updated, to keep their term descriptions and references up to date with current scientific knowledge and resources as well as legislative definitions
- Modifications were performed in existing codes from different hierarchies and/or facets which were associated with update/addition of common names (n=31) and scientific names (n= 32), update of the term extended name (n= 40), and removal of existing common names (n= 7)
- New terms (n=14) were added in different hierarchies and/or facets in accordance with the One Health Surveillance data collection

- The mapping between FoodEx2 terms with the F33- Legislative - classes defined in the Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on food additives as implicit facets were updated in accordance with Food Additives and Food Flavourings Monitoring
- New terms were created in different hierarchies and facets to facilitate the exposure assessment work performed for food additives
- The Birds section was amended to accommodate Avian Influenza data collection and to complete taxonomy of existing species
- The Plants section was updated with new terms to support the needs of the NORA project making FoodEx2 more flexible and suitable for future data entries related to NFs
- New terms and facet descriptors were added in different hierarchies to accommodate the needs of the food composition data collection within the context of the EU FCDB
- Five terms were dismissed from different hierarchies as found redundant, or not in line with the data used
- The position of some terms in the hierarchy tree was changed since a better parent-child term relationship was found mostly due to the addition of new terms
- The applicability of some terms was extended to further hierarchies.

The complete content of the FoodEx2 system is available in Appendix B to this document, as exported spreadsheet MTX_17.0.xlsx.

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Abbreviations

DF	Data Framework
EC	European Commission
EFSA	European Food Safety Authority
EU FCDB	European Food Composition Database
EU	European Union
FoodEx2	Food Classification and Description System
IDATA	Integrated Data
ISA	Individual Scientific Advisors
MRL	Maximum Residue Limit
MTX	FoodEx2 Matrix hierarchy
NF	Novel Food
NORA	Novel Foods Risk Assessment Data Modelling and Extraction
PRIMo	Pesticides Residue Intake Model
TG	Technical Group

Appendix A – New terms added and changes made during the 2025 maintenance

Appendix B – FoodEx2 catalogue MTX_17.0